Cyber Crime Case Studies

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A detailed analysis of real-world cyber incidents, their impact and key lessons for a safer digital future.

CASE 1 — CRIME THRIVES ONLINE, LITTLE ACTION ON GROUND (MUMBAI, INDIA)



Mumbai/METRO

VETERAN CONGRESS LEADER RK DHAWAN PASSES AWAY AT 81 IN DELHI >HT NATION P9

Crime thrives online, little action on ground

LOW CONVICTIONS Experts blame lack of manpower, poor training

Vijay Kumar Yadav & Jayprakash S Naidu

MUMBAI: The state government in April this year, approved the setting up of four new police stations dedicated to tackling the rising cases of cyber crime in Mumbai. It also sanctioned creating 186 new posts, most of them to be filled by assistant police inspectors.

These units are yet to start work, but meanwhile, cases of cyber crime—which range from data theft to credit and debit card fraud and vishing—have steadily risen over the past three years. Convictions, however, have remained disproportionately low. According to the National Crime Records Bureau's (NCRB) 2016 report on crime, Mumbai ranked first in the country for cyber crime cases. From 2015, up until May 2018, 10,275 cyber crime cases were filed in Maharashtra. While 3,680 of these were solved by the police, just 93 of these cases went to trial. In all, since 2015, there have been convictions only in 28 cases.

"The detection (solving) rate depends on several factors," said Balsing Rajput, the superintendent of police (cyber).

"It is difficult to extract information in cyber crime cases. There are many agencies involved, such as the internet service provider, the ones who provide media content online, intermediaries like the bank's and technology service providers. There is also the issue of international jurisdiction."

Rajput pointed out how in many cases, the fraudsters use SIM cards that they got after providing false information.

"The bank accounts of an illiterate person is used, after these fraudsters promise them a commission.".

Former Maharashtra director general of police and cyber crime expert, D Sivanandhan, said one of the main reasons for low detection and conviction rates was the lack of manpower and poorly trained police officers.

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>RELATED REPORTS, P2

CASES RISE, CONVICTIONS FALL

4,035 Cyber crime cases registered in 2017, nearly double the number of cases (2,195) since 2015

16.6% Was the conviction rate in 2017, down from 40.7% in 2015

12 Cases went to trial and were concluded in 2017, much lower than 2015's 54 cases

0 Convictions in 2018, despite all 10 registered cases going to trial, (ended in acquittals)

25.7 was the detection rate (an avg of cases solved) in 2017, down from 35.3 in 2015.

■ Cases ■ Detection

2015 2,195 — Trials completed 54 | Convictions 22

2016 2,380 — Trials completed 17 | Convictions 4

2017 4,035 — Trials completed 12 | Convictions 2

2018 May 1,665 — Trials completed 10 | Convictions 0

(Source: Maharashtra Police)

Hindustan Times (Mumbai), 7 August 2018: "Crime thrives online, little action on ground."

IMAGE DESCRIPTION

The clipping reports that cyber crime cases in Mumbai and Maharashtra were rising sharply while convictions were falling. Its chart (source: Maharashtra Police) compares cases registered, trials completed and convictions for 2015 to May 2018. Experts quoted blame the shortage of manpower and poor training.

1) NEWS HISTORY — WHAT HAPPENED?

According to the clipping, the Maharashtra government approved four new cyber police stations in Mumbai, with new posts to be filled by assistant police inspectors, but the units had not yet started work. Cases such as data theft, credit and debit card fraud and vishing had increased over the previous three years. The article reports 4,035 cyber crime cases registered in 2017, nearly double the 2,195 cases of 2015. The conviction rate was reported as 16.6% in 2017, down from 40.7% in 2015, and no convictions were recorded in the first months of 2018 even though all 10 cases that went to trial had been concluded.

SOURCE / NEWS REFERENCE

Hindustan Times, Mumbai/Metro edition, 7 August 2018, by Vijay Kumar Yadav and Jayprakash S Naidu; statistics attributed in the article to Maharashtra Police and the NCRB 2016 report.

2) ATTACK TECHNIQUE

The clipping describes common cyber crimes: data theft, credit and debit card fraud and vishing (voice-call phishing). It also notes that fraudsters use SIM cards obtained with false information and move money through accounts of unsuspecting people, which makes tracing them difficult, especially when service providers are located in other jurisdictions.

3) TOTAL LOSS / FINANCIAL IMPACT

The clipping does not give a total money-loss figure. The main impact it highlights is on justice and trust: many victims' cases are registered but few reach trial, and very few end in conviction, so offenders face little deterrence.

4) RECOVERY — COMPANY / AUTHORITY RESPONSE

The state approved four new cyber police stations and new posts. Experts said manpower, training and quicker cooperation from banks, telecom companies and internet intermediaries were needed. At the time of the report the new units had not begun working.

5) RECOVERY COST AND RECOVERY TIME

No cost or recovery time is stated in the clipping. The article suggests that improvement would take years because units had to be staffed and officers trained.

6) HOW COULD IT HAVE BEEN PREVENTED?

Train police in digital forensics; staff cyber units properly; speed up information-sharing with banks, telecom providers and platforms; enforce strict identity checks for SIM cards and accounts; build international cooperation for evidence; and run public-awareness campaigns on vishing and card fraud.

SOLUTION / KEY LESSON

Technology alone does not stop cyber crime. Trained investigators, working legal channels and cooperation between police, banks and telecom companies are needed to turn registered cases into convictions.

CASE 2 — CYBERCRIME NO LESS THAN TERRORISM (INDIA)



lokmat Times

India is second in the world in terms of internet users, but it is far behind vis-a-vis cyber security

Cybercrime no less than terrorism

Vijay Darda

The news that the debit and credit cards of 1.3 million Indians are available for sale on a site on 'Dark Web' in itself is bizarre and worrisome. It is obvious that only cyber criminals will buy them and cheat or commit cyber robbery. This is not the first time this has happened. Only last year, it was reported that some 32 lakh debit/credit cards of Indians were hacked by criminals. How much loss has been caused to these card holders is not known, exactly yet. Yes, it has been stated in the Norton Cyber Security Insight Report that in 2017, the Indians who were the victims of cybercrime lost $18.5 billion.

This report states that of all the people who use Internet in India, two of every five people invariably fall prey to some kind of cyber attack. They realise only after suffering the loss. The loss in India is usually not compensated. There are two reasons for this. One, there is no strong security system against cybercrime with no intensity in investigation and security, there is still not much awareness about insurance. There are only a few companies in the insurance sector which are offering this service. You will be surprised to know that the total cyber insurance business in India is only 1.6 per cent compared to the US. Most policies are taken by companies or institutions. Fewer people take the policy personally. This policy mainly compensates for losses due to recovery, phishing, email spoofing and unauthorised online transactions.

In America and the developed countries in Europe, the security situation seems much better. When my son Devendra was working after completing his studies in the US, the cyber criminals had withdrawn the entire amount from his bank account. After he complained to the bank, the matter was investigated promptly. You will be surprised to know that within eight days all the money was returned to the account. The situation is not so in our country even today. Although the Reserve Bank of India has issued several advisories, unfortunately there is no awareness among people.

Recently, people received an SMS saying that an amount of ₹80,000 is being credited to their provident fund account. It also asked people to check their names in the list. When people opened the site, the PAN card number was being asked there. Obviously, those who did not exercise caution, must have fallen victim to it.

Phishing messages in the name of banks and through phone calls keep coming but what is surprising is that people get trapped! In fact, with the world going digital at a faster pace, the threat of cyber attack is also increasing with the same speed. Your data is very important and it is being stolen. It is very difficult to understand when and how it will be misused.

A few days back, IT company Cisco released a report which clearly states that in the year 2018-19, there were a large number of cyber attacks on companies working in the field of banking, finance and infrastructure in India and on an average every company suffered a loss of about ₹25 crore. But I believe that if cyber security is given due attention, it can be dealt with. In September this year, the first National Conference on Cybercrime Investigation and Cyber Forensics was held at CBI headquarters in New Delhi. Let's hope a system will be put in place soon to enable India to crack down on cyber criminals.

There is an urgent need for India to be more vigilant because we are the second largest users of Internet in the world. Worldwide, 3.8 billion people use the Internet, of which 12 per cent are Indians. Even America, at eight per cent, is behind us. China is at number one with 21 per cent. We have many Apps to use for money transactions here. In such a situation, there is always a danger of cyber attack on banks. There have also been several incidents of Aadhaar data leakage. In fact, the companies to whom we give our data should also make strong security arrangements. Everyone knows the story of data leaks from Facebook. British Airways was even fined $229 million for this. Hackers are inventing new technology every day. We have to be on guard against them. I feel cybercrime is no less than terrorism by any measure. Terrorists kill people. Cyber criminals kill them financially.

And this news is worrying too that Indian politicians, businessmen, media persons, activists, lawyers, journalists and people associated with human rights are being spied through Israeli software. Congress on Sunday alleged that the party general secretary Priyanka Gandhi's phone was hacked too. NCP leader Praful Patel too fell victim to such an attack. The question that arises is who is spying. The answer to this question must be found. If this question is not answered, several doubts arise. Why was such a situation of doubts created should also be deliberated upon. The government should strictly tighten the screws on members of such cyber criminals so that no Indian is afraid that their personal information may get stolen. The government should assure that it is there to protect them!

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Just as the world of internet is expanding, so are cyber criminals. From banks and big companies to the common man, everyone is under cyber threat. In fact, cybercrime is no less than terrorism by any measure. It is not only a financial robbery but also an attack on the right to privacy.

Nagpur Main
Page No. 6 Nov 04, 2019
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Lokmat Times (Nagpur Main), 4 November 2019: opinion article "Cybercrime no less than terrorism" by Vijay Darda.

IMAGE DESCRIPTION

This opinion article argues that cybercrime should be treated as seriously as terrorism. It begins with the news that debit and credit card details of about 1.3 million Indians were reported to be on sale on a dark-web site, and says India ranks second in internet users but lags in cyber security.

1) NEWS HISTORY — WHAT HAPPENED?

The article reports that card data of around 1.3 million Indians was being offered for sale on a dark-web site and uses this to argue that India's cyber security and public awareness are weak. It cites a 2017 Norton report saying Indian victims of cybercrime lost about US$18.5 billion, and points to the growth of internet and digital payments as a reason why the threat is increasing. It calls for stronger systems, investigation capacity and awareness.

SOURCE / NEWS REFERENCE

Lokmat Times, Nagpur Main, page 6, 4 November 2019, opinion column by Vijay Darda. Figures are as quoted in the article and have not been independently verified here.

2) ATTACK TECHNIQUE

The clipping is an opinion piece and does not describe how the card data was obtained. Card data sold on dark-web markets commonly comes from card skimming, compromised payment systems, malware or phishing. The article also refers to fraud through phishing messages and calls pretending to be from banks.

3) TOTAL LOSS / FINANCIAL IMPACT

The article cites the 2017 Norton estimate of US$18.5 billion lost by Indian cybercrime victims and warns of financial fraud and attacks on people's privacy. These are quoted figures, not verified totals for this specific card-data case.

4) RECOVERY — COMPANY / AUTHORITY RESPONSE

The article calls for stronger cyber security systems, better investigation and forensic capacity, wider awareness among the public and more use of cyber insurance. In incidents of leaked card data, banks typically block and reissue the affected cards and ask customers to watch for suspicious transactions.

5) RECOVERY COST AND RECOVERY TIME

No verified recovery cost or time is given in the clipping. Costs of such leaks include card reissuance, fraud reimbursement, investigation and loss of customer trust.

6) HOW COULD IT HAVE BEEN PREVENTED?

Use chip-and-PIN and tokenised card payments; monitor for suspicious transactions in real time; secure payment systems and ATMs against skimming; warn customers never to share OTPs or PINs; and strengthen national cyber-security capacity and awareness.

SOLUTION / KEY LESSON

Cybercrime is a national security and economic issue, not only a technical problem. Awareness, strong payment security and well-equipped investigators all need to work together.

CASE 3 — PUNE CYBER FRAUDS: 1,392 INCIDENTS, RS. 402 CRORE LOST (INDIA)



Pune Mirror

Cybercrimes up: City records 3 cases daily

Punekars lose ₹402.42 crore in 1,392 incidents of cyber frauds reported this year

Pune Mirror: "Cybercrimes up: City records 3 cases daily." (The date is not visible in the supplied image.)

IMAGE DESCRIPTION

The clipping reports that cyber fraud in Pune was rising, with about three cases recorded every day. Its headline figures say Punekars lost about Rs. 402.42 crore in 1,392 reported cyber-fraud incidents during the year. A side box explains "digital arrest" scams.

1) NEWS HISTORY — WHAT HAPPENED?

According to the clipping, 1,392 cyber-fraud cases were reported in the year, with money siphoned from citizens' bank accounts at an average of roughly Rs. 1.1 crore per day. Only a small number of cases had been detected and arrested by then (the article mentions 29 detections and 21 arrests), while the police had frozen about Rs. 14.34 crore in various accounts and recovered about Rs. 1.31 crore. The article also raises the issue of misuse of identity documents and explains digital-arrest scams.

SOURCE / NEWS REFERENCE

Pune Mirror clipping supplied with this assignment, headline "Cybercrimes up: City records 3 cases daily"; figures are as quoted in the article (low image resolution, so please verify against the original).

2) ATTACK TECHNIQUE

The sidebar describes "digital arrest" fraud: criminals pose as police or other law-enforcement officers, frighten the victim with false accusations, often on a video call, and pressure the person to transfer money. The article also points to other online frauds and to the misuse of identity documents, which helps criminals create accounts or SIMs that are hard to trace.

3) TOTAL LOSS / FINANCIAL IMPACT

The clipping reports a total loss of about Rs. 402.42 crore across 1,392 incidents in the year. Beyond money, victims face fear, loss of savings and loss of trust in digital payments.

4) RECOVERY — COMPANY / AUTHORITY RESPONSE

The police reported freezing about Rs. 14.34 crore in various accounts and recovering about Rs. 1.31 crore, and said a small number of cases had been detected with arrests made. The article also calls for better handling of identity documents and for public awareness of digital-arrest scams.

5) RECOVERY COST AND RECOVERY TIME

The amount recovered (about Rs. 1.31 crore) is small compared with the Rs. 402.42 crore lost, which shows how hard recovery is. Quick reporting helps, because funds can only be frozen while they are still in the accounts.

6) HOW COULD IT HAVE BEEN PREVENTED?

Remember that no genuine police or government agency arrests people over a video call or asks for money transfers; hang up and call the national cyber-crime helpline 1930 or report on cybercrime.gov.in immediately; never share OTPs or PINs; verify unknown callers; do not install apps on request; and dispose of identity documents safely.

SOLUTION / KEY LESSON

Fast reporting is the best defence after a fraud, but awareness is the best defence before it. Banks, police and citizens must act quickly because stolen money moves between accounts within minutes.

CASE 4 — SEXTORTION AND CYBER BULLYING (INDORE, INDIA)



SUNDAY TIMES OF INDIA, INDORE
APRIL 8, 2018

TIMES

Rising 'sextortion' cases put cyber users on the edge

Video Calls, Chats Used To Blackmail Net Users

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Indore: Small chat on messenger followed by a video call with exchange of compromising messages two months ago, changed the life of a 25-year-old IT professional Shikhar Singh (name changed) who became a victim when scammers from the other end started blackmailing him.

Shikhar had been in a relationship with a woman for past six years but the recorded video call and subsequent harassment that followed broke him.

He is one of the thousands of people in India caught by a growing internet scam the investigators call 'sextortion'. Here the scammers usually monitor activities of their targets online for days and weeks. After sifting through all the profile details, relationship links, profile pictures, activities and victim's habits based on the update, a friend request is sent and conversation is initiated.

The woman on the other end sends objectionable pictures to the victim and asks him to do the same. In most of the cases, the video that victim sees is either a pre-recorded video or a completely fake one. While the victim imagines that he is chatting with a woman, there is a man who is texting him. They work in groups together.

Such scams wherein a victim is duped into performing a sexual act by unknown, attractive women, is rising in India. While women continue to be at the receiving end of revenge porn, online abuse and harassment, most of the victims are men, claim experts.

"In the past three months, ten people have come to me with such cases as they do not want to approach police. Six of them were men," said Ritesh Bhatia, cyber expert.

Bhatia said that the crime 'sextortion' can be divided into three types—one which is done for physical relations, second is asking for more such videos and third is extorting money using the videos or images available. According to Bhatia, many cases similar to that of Shikhar have been recorded in the recent past.

The scammers also threaten to share the video of the sexual act with relatives or friends if the ransom is delayed.

Experts helping victims deal with such cases claim that such accused are part of sophisticated and organised gangs. While no police records are available on the increase in such cases in cyber space, cyber experts claimed that more than 50% women online have reported some or the other form of cyber abuse. "It can be anything starting from stalking, harassment, sharing obscene content etc," said Shaik Javeed Ahmed, cyber expert.

Meanwhile, for Singh, the story is far from over. Weeks after the incident, he continues to live in fear. "He has deleted his Facebook account and is completely broken," said the psychologist dealing with him.

TAKE PRECAUTIONS WHILE SHARING INFO ONLINE

- Use least amount of information necessary to register for and using the site. Opt for nickname or handle
- Use highest level privacy setting that a site allows & don't accept default settings
- Make sure you cover web cameras of laptops, mobile phone when not in use
- Verify emails, links in emails you get from social networking sites. They are often designed to gain access to your personal information
- Be certain of both the source and content of each file you download. When in doubt, don't open or download any content shared with you
- Never post publicly your address, phone number, driver's licence number, Aadhaar number, PAN card or student ID number
- Only connect with people you know and trust
- Read privacy and security policies closely - know what you are getting into. Some major social networking sites actually say they will use or sell information about you in order to display advertising or other information they believe might be useful to you

Cyber bullying makes the victims feel extremely guilty

Q&A

Niraii Bhatia
psychologist

How many cases of cyber bullying and sextortion do you come across every month and how you deal with the victims?
I deal with a number of cases on a day to day basis through social media, over mails or calls. Most of the victims, who approach me, come with extreme suicidal thoughts. I first make sure that they are safe and then speak about the issue. We provide whatever technical help we can but once a video or a picture is uploaded, it is very difficult to take it back. So it's important that the victim is counselled in a proper way to deal with the situation.

How does cyber bullying affect the victims?
The impact of cyber bullying and sextortion on the victims is so severe that they feel extremely guilty. We have to put them on medications as the trauma is deep and painful. In one of the cases, the victim was so paranoid after the incident that he stopped using social media and used to think that people are staring at him.

What should people do to avoid being dragged into such crimes?
One should always stick to basic instinct and common sense to avoid such things. If you feel that someone seems suspicious, do not talk to that person. Even if you fall prey to sextortion or cyber bullying, remember that it's not the end of the world and you can be saved by right kind of technical and psychological help.

Sunday Times of India, Indore, 8 April 2018: "Rising 'sextortion' cases put cyber users on the edge."

IMAGE DESCRIPTION

The clipping reports a rise in sextortion, where criminals use video calls and chats to record or capture private content and then blackmail the victim for money. It also carries a list of precautions for sharing information online and a psychologist's Q&A; on cyber bullying.

1) NEWS HISTORY — WHAT HAPPENED?

According to the clipping, cyber users were increasingly being targeted through social media and messaging platforms. Criminals befriend victims, move the conversation to video calls or chats, record or capture compromising content and threaten to share it with family and friends unless money is paid. The article says many victims stay silent out of shame and fear, which makes the crime hard to detect.

SOURCE / NEWS REFERENCE

Sunday Times of India, Indore edition, 8 April 2018, "Rising 'sextortion' cases put cyber users on the edge", with a Q&A; with a psychologist on cyber bullying.

2) ATTACK TECHNIQUE

The technique is social engineering and blackmail. Fraudsters create fake or attractive profiles, build trust, persuade the victim to join a video call or share private content, record it and then demand money under threat of public exposure.

3) TOTAL LOSS / FINANCIAL IMPACT

The clipping gives no total figure. Victims may lose money to repeated demands and suffer serious emotional harm, including guilt, anxiety and fear of social embarrassment. The psychologist in the article stresses that victims often feel extremely guilty even though they are the ones being wronged.

4) RECOVERY — COMPANY / AUTHORITY RESPONSE

The article advises victims not to pay, to preserve evidence such as chats and numbers, and to report to the police or cyber-crime cell. The psychologist adds that victims should seek emotional support and understand that the blame lies with the blackmailer.

5) RECOVERY COST AND RECOVERY TIME

No recovery cost or time is stated. Recovery is mainly emotional and legal: removing threatened content, filing a complaint and supporting the victim. Paying usually does not stop the blackmail.

6) HOW COULD IT HAVE BEEN PREVENTED?

Use the highest privacy settings on social media; accept requests only from people you know; share the minimum personal information; cover webcams when not in use; avoid unknown video calls; verify emails and links before clicking; never post personal details such as address or phone number publicly; and read privacy policies before using a site.

SOLUTION / KEY LESSON

Sextortion works because of shame and secrecy. Victims should report quickly without guilt, and everyone should limit what they share with strangers online.

CASE 5 — CYBER CRIME IN VULNERABLE STATES AND CITIES OF INDIA (RESEARCH PAPER)



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Page Number: 43-48

Cyber Crime: An Analytical Study of Cyber Crime Cases at the Most Vulnerable States and Cities in India.

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ABSTRACT
In this age of information and technology, Internet plays the pivotal role for the exchange of huge amount of information. It influences not only all spheres of human life but also all age groups of man. Even if the internet has changed our society fundamentally, the information over internet is not free from any illegal access or harm. Thus the security and safety of information has become the major challenge of the present time. With the rapid growth of users, the cyber crime cases are also increasing and are not restricted by any geographical limitations or national boundaries in the world. Over the past few years India has witnessed many cyber crime cases. And it is a matter of great concern as it has direct negative impact on economic and social lives of people. Our research work is based on the quantitative analysis of cyber crime cases under the IT Act and Indian Penal Code in top vulnerable states and cities in India. Further the cyber crime cases committed by the people of different age group have been analyzed. And along with the description of different motives of cyber crime activities and the offences, the important remedial measures have been suggested that need to be taken to minimize the cyber crime cases.

Keywords— Cyber crime, IT Act, Indian Penal Code, Offences

I. INTRODUCTION

Today's world is an information rich world and thus computer has become a necessity for every field of human life. In this age of information and technology, internet plays the pivotal role for the exchange of huge amount of information. But the information over internet is not free from any illegal access or harm. It is found that in the current decade, there is a remarkable increase of crime rate on internet. Thus the security and safety of information has become the major challenge of the present time. The crime on internet is termed as cyber crime and in simple meaning cyber crime is unlawful acts wherein the computer is either a target or a tool or both.

And in other words cyber Crime as Criminal activity directly related to the use of computers, specifically illegal trespass into the computer system or database of another, manipulation or theft of stored or on-line data, or sabotage of equipment and data[1]. In the current era of online processing, maximum of the information is online and prone to cyber threats [6].Cyber crime is regulated by cyber laws or internet laws. Cyber law is a term which refers to all the legal and regulatory aspects of Internet and the World Wide Web. Anything concerned with or related to, or emanating from, any legal aspects or issues concerning any activity of natives and others, in cyber space comes within the ambit of Cyber law [11].The criminal activities that are traditional in nature such as theft, fraud, forgery, defamation and mischief are subject to the Indian Penal Code whereas the abuse of computers such as hacking, phishing, Email Spoofing, Email spamming, Email bombing etc. are addressed by the Information Technology Act 2000.

II. CYBER LAWS: IPC AND IT ACT 2000

Cyber law is important because it touches almost all aspects of transactions and activities on and concerning the internet, the World Wide Web and Cyberspace. Cyber laws are meant to set the definite pattern, some rules and guidelines that define the different business activities going on through internet and categorize the activities as legal and illegal. The activities which are illegal are punishable as per the laws. Cyber crimes can involve criminal activities that are traditional in nature such as theft, fraud, forgery, defamation and mischief, all of which are subject to the Indian Penal Code.

In the Year 2000, India enacted its first law on Information Technology which is called Information Technology act 2000.The IT Act 2000 attempts to change

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First page of "Cyber Crime: An Analytical Study of Cyber Crime Cases at the Most Vulnerable States and Cities in India", IJEMR, Vol. 5, Issue 2, April 2015, pp. 43–48.

IMAGE DESCRIPTION

This is an academic research paper rather than a newspaper report. It is by Y. Karali, S. Panda and C. S. Panda of Sambalpur University, Odisha, and analyses cyber crime cases registered in Indian states and cities, with reference to the Information Technology Act and the Indian Penal Code.

1) NEWS HISTORY — WHAT HAPPENED?

The abstract explains that internet use has grown rapidly and that cyber crime has become a major concern in India because it crosses geographical and national boundaries. The authors study cases under the IT Act and the Indian Penal Code in the most vulnerable states and cities, discuss the motives behind cyber crime and suggest remedial measures to reduce it.

SOURCE / NEWS REFERENCE

Y. Karali, S. Panda and C. S. Panda, International Journal of Engineering and Management Research (IJEMR), Vol. 5, Issue 2, April 2015, pp. 43–48, Vandana Publications. Only the first page was supplied, so details here are limited to it.

2) ATTACK TECHNIQUE

The first page describes cyber crime in general terms: illegal acts in which a computer is the target or the tool, including hacking, phishing, email spoofing, email spamming and email bombing, which are covered by the Information Technology Act, 2000.

3) TOTAL LOSS / FINANCIAL IMPACT

The first page does not give financial figures. It explains that cyber crime affects the economic and social lives of people, and that the paper's analysis counts cases by state and city.

4) RECOVERY — COMPANY / AUTHORITY RESPONSE

The paper discusses the legal response through the IT Act, 2000 and the IPC, and suggests remedial measures, such as stronger enforcement, awareness and better laws, to reduce cyber crime.

5) RECOVERY COST AND RECOVERY TIME

Not applicable: the paper is an analytical study, not a single incident, and the supplied page gives no cost or recovery time.

6) HOW COULD IT HAVE BEEN PREVENTED?

Spread cyber-security awareness; train law-enforcement staff in cyber forensics; strengthen and update cyber laws; use strong passwords and multi-factor authentication; keep software patched; and encourage reporting of cyber crimes.

SOLUTION / KEY LESSON

Understanding where and why cyber crime happens helps governments and organisations target prevention. Laws such as the IT Act 2000 are important, but they need awareness, capacity and enforcement to work.